

Make a Movie



Mom, this documentary about life in a forest is so interesting! Wouldn't it be cool if I could make one?

You can, I just made one last week for work.

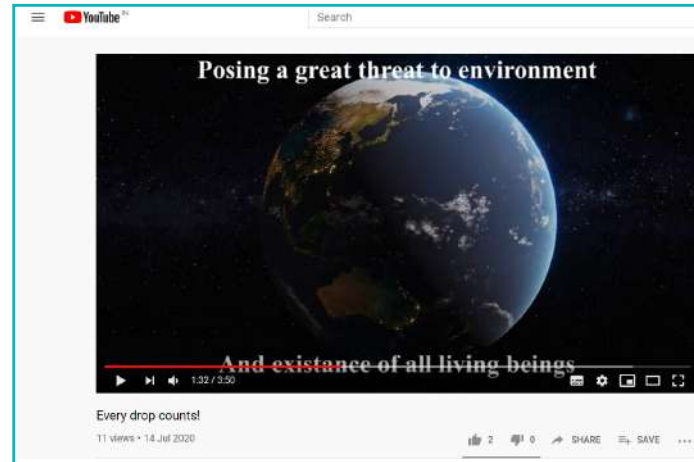
Sure! We can make a short video about the importance of water.

Will you teach me?



Movie making is the process of visual storytelling which uses audio and video media. We watch videos, short films, and movies every day. They can be used to spread awareness, tell stories, and share ideas. We will make a short movie about the importance of water, which can reach people anywhere in the world.

By the end of this lesson, we will have a movie that looks like this: <https://youtu.be/et2i0xj15eY>.



To make it easy, we will create a plan for how to make a movie.

STORY

- Every movie or documenta idea or story.

Media creation

- This is the process where video and audio clips are identified or created as per the script.

Script

- A story is written in the form of scenes and dialogues to create a script.

Editing

- This process combines video and audio files to create an engaging movie.

We already have an idea or story for the movie; we want to spread awareness about importance of water. Now, for the script, we will refer to the following text:

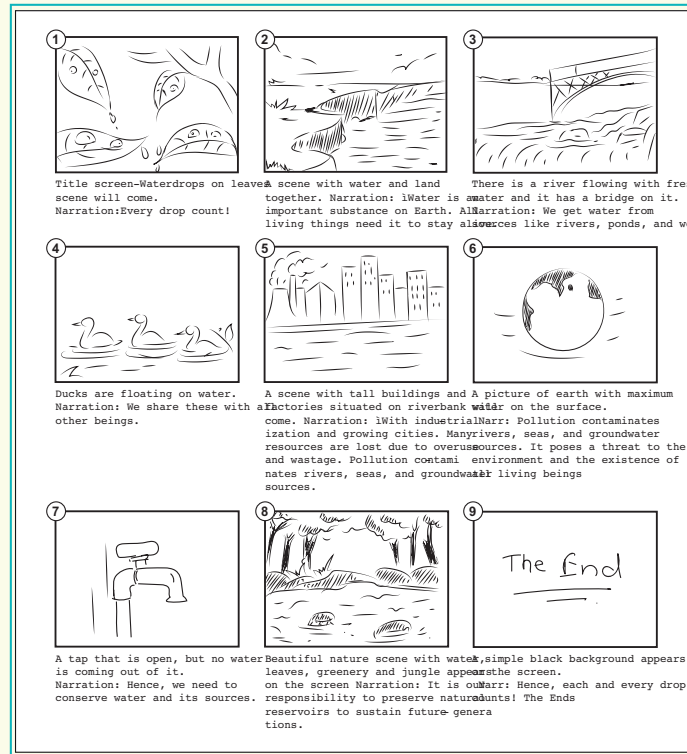
Every drop Counts!

“Water is an important substance on Earth. All living things need it to stay alive. We get water from sources like rivers, ponds, and wells. We share these with all other beings.

With industrialization and growing cities, many resources are lost due to overuse and wastage. Pollution contaminates rivers, seas, and groundwater sources. It poses a threat to the environment and the existence of all living beings. Hence, we need to conserve water and its sources. It is our responsibility to preserve natural reservoirs to sustain future generations.”

The idea and script for the movie is ready. We will use images, audio, and text to create it. We will gather images related to our script and make a storyboard.

Note: A storyboard is a graphical representation of a story in the form of images or illustrations. They are added in a sequence to visualise a movie, animation, or interactive media like games.



Exercise

Fill in the blanks

- 1** Movie making is the process of _____ in video and audio media formats.
- 2** _____, _____, _____, and _____, are the steps of movie making.

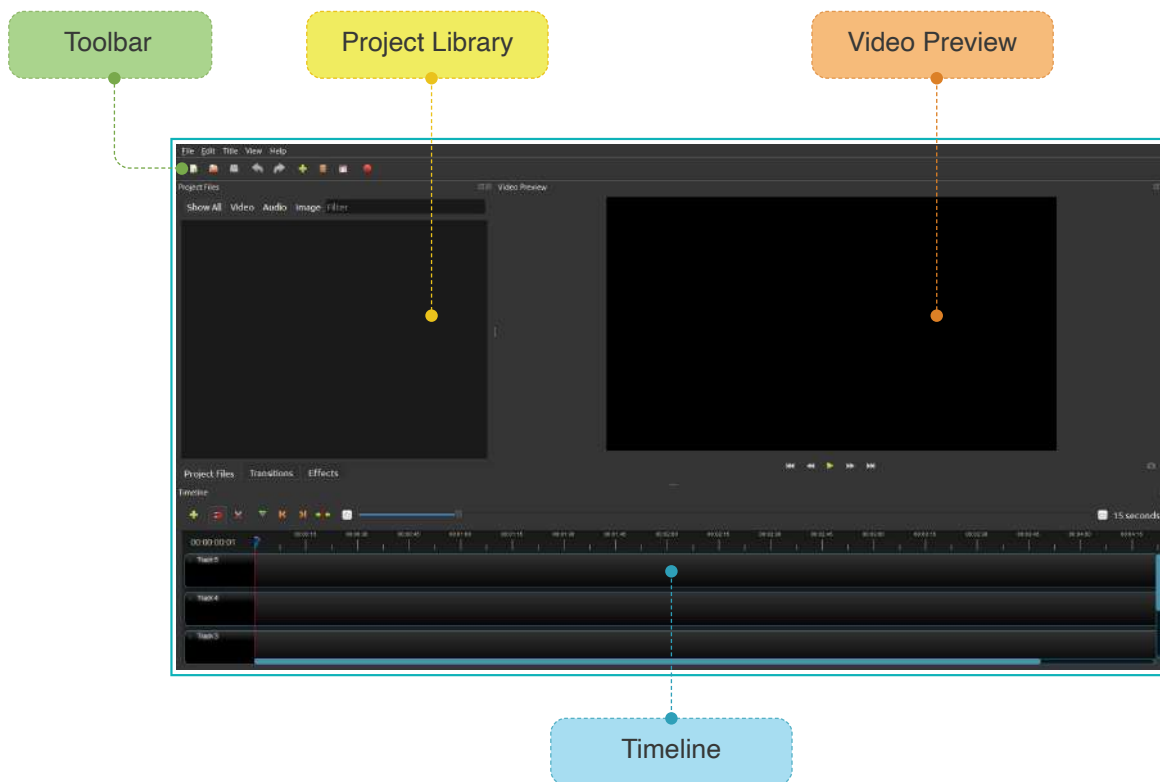
To make a video or movie with these images, we need to use a video editor. We will use a software that is free for all: OpenShot.



11. Make a Movie

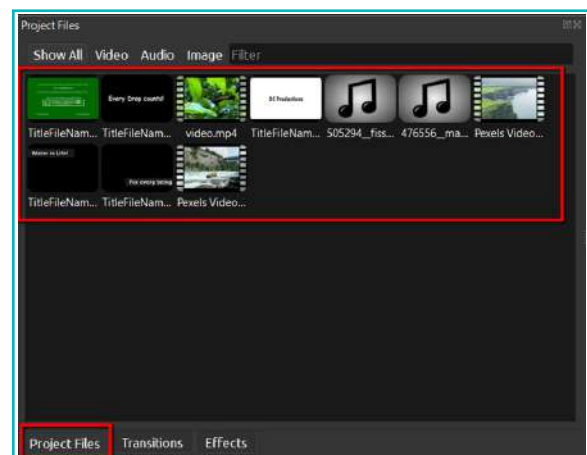
When we start the OpenShot video editor, we first see the dashboard. It has four main areas:

1. **Toolbar:** It has buttons to open, save, undo, redo, and export the video project.
2. **Project Library:** It contains resources used to edit and create a film.
3. **Video Preview:** This shows a preview of how the final video will look.
4. **Timeline:** This is the area where we arrange media files in a sequence with respect to time.



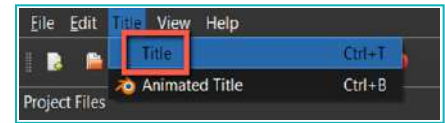
The project library area has three function tabs:

1. **Project files:** This displays the image, audio and video files added to use for the movie.
2. **Transitions:** These are video effects that are used between two video clips put together.
3. **Effects:** These are visual effects that can be applied to videos to change their appearance.



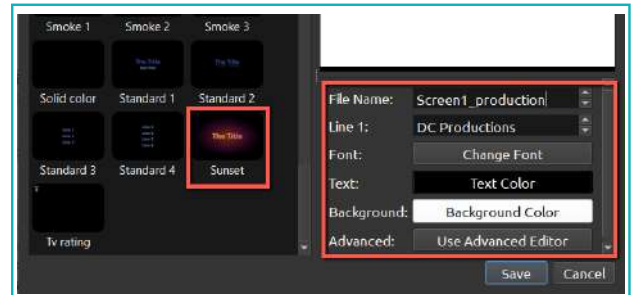
11. Make a Movie

At start of a movie, we see the name of the production company and the movie's title. We will add a fictional production company name and title. In the "Title" options bar, select Title from the drop down.



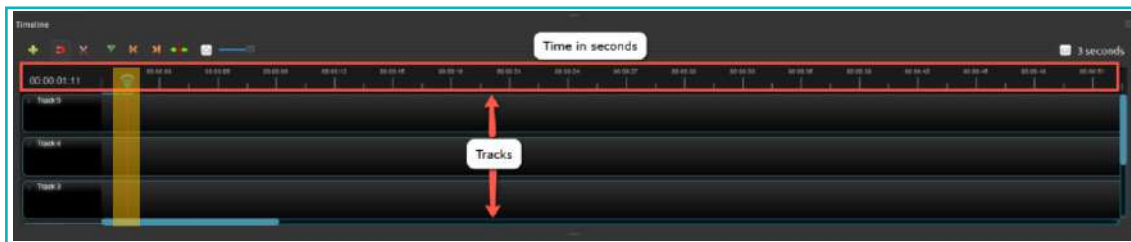
Title displays template options for the title screen:

- Select a template for the centre title. This will be for the production name. E.g. Sunset.
- Change the file name to screen1_production and the text in line1 to a fictional production name. We will use "DC Productions".
- Change the background colour, text colour and font. Click on save to add the title screen to Project files.



Note: Do not use a company name that already exists, they are all copyrighted.

Since our first scene is ready, let's use 'Timeline' to set the time for it.



Timeline

This is the area where media files are arranged in a sequence with respect to time.

Ruler

Time is displayed in a scale format at the top. This indicates the time a media file is played.

Play head

The red vertical line with a blue head, highlighted in yellow, represents the current playback position.

11. Make a Movie

Tracks

Tracks are layers in which images, audios, and videos can be added in a sequence.

Snapping



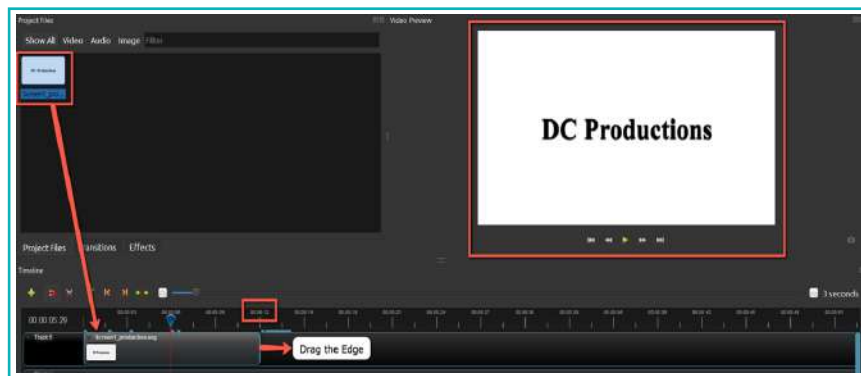
Snapping helps to line up the audio, video, or play head at a specific position.

Timeline has three layers, top layer, second layer and third layer.

In this activity, top layer or track will be for titles or text, second layer will be for videos and third layer will be for audio.

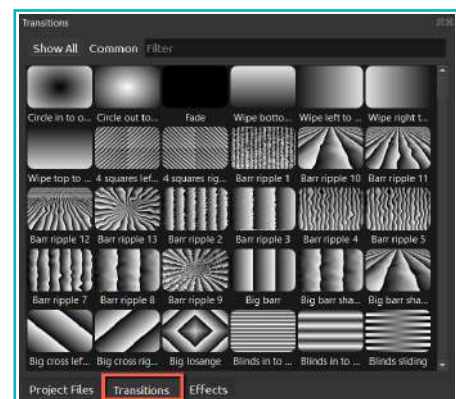
To add a title or image to the video frame, drag it from the project file pane to the timeline. The default length of a title and image clip is 10 seconds.

- Add screen1_production clip to timeline track 5.
- Drag the right edge of the 10 second clip in the track up to 12 seconds.



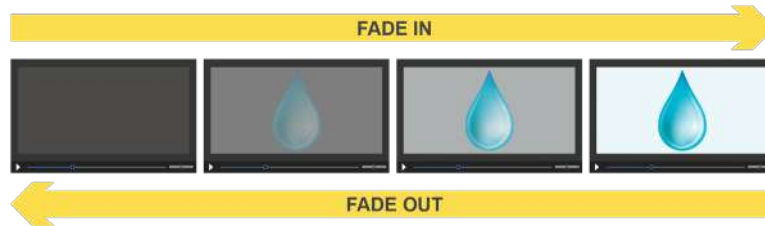
If we click play in the preview screen, the video will play for 12 seconds and display the production title. But right now, the scene appears and ends abruptly, which doesn't look good. We will add the transition effect 'fade in-fade-out' to the movie clip.

Transitions are animated effects which can be added from the transitions tab. They can overlap between two clips or play during the entire clip. On the timeline, they are highlighted in blue.



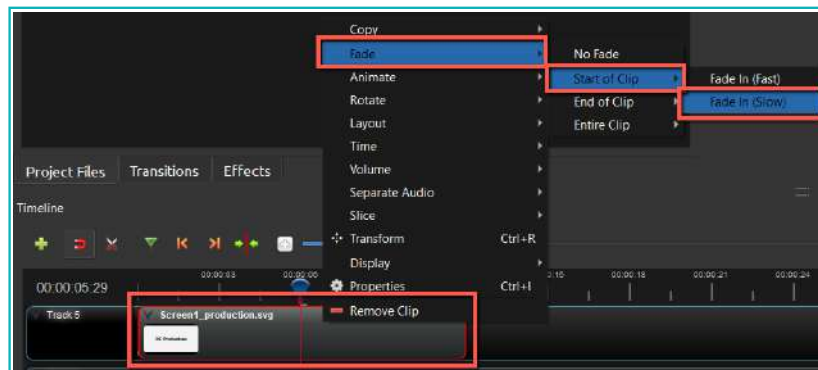
Fade

This effect changes the opacity of an image or video at the start or end of a scene. It is used for a smooth beginning or end.



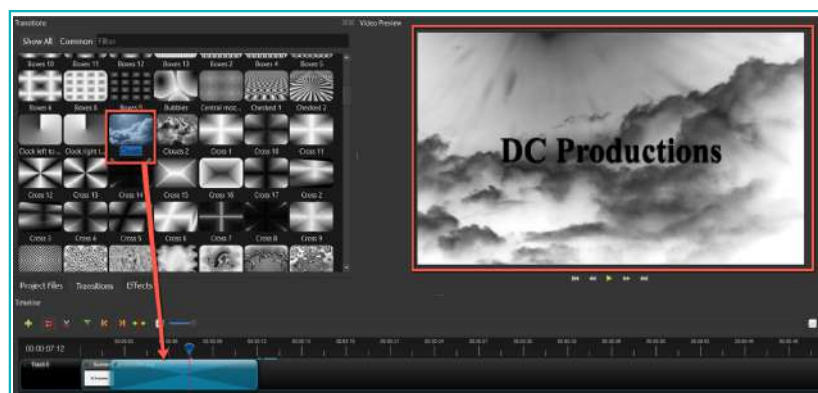
Fade in makes an image or video appear slowly from a blank screen at the beginning. Fade out makes a video or image slowly disappear into black at the end of a clip.

- Right click on the screen1 clip on track 5 and select Fade > Start of clip > Fade in (Slow). This will add a slow fade in effect at the beginning of the clip. Playback to view the effect.
- Similarly, add a fast fade out effect at the end of the clip. Observe the difference between slow and fast fade effects.



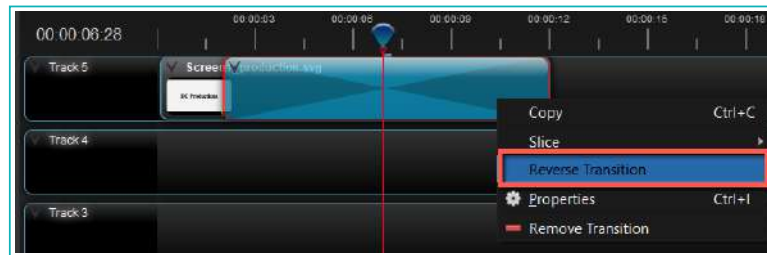
We will look at some more transitions:

- Click on the transitions tab in the project library.
- Select and drag the cloud effect and add to timeline track 5 for the duration of screen1 clip.
- Align the end of the clip with the effect window.

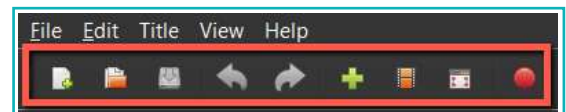


Play the clip. We can see that the transition starts with a black out, which doesn't look good. In this case, we can reverse the existing transition to add a fade out effect at end of the clip. This will be a better transition.

f. Right click on the effect (in blue) and click on Reverse Transition. Play the video to see how it looks.

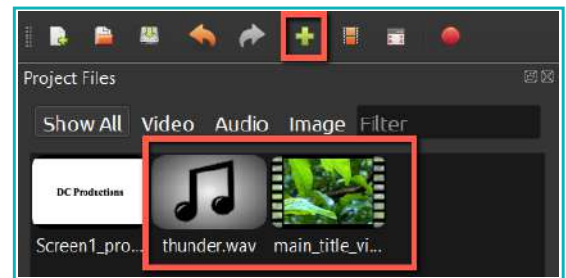


We will use the toolbar to add resources to the project library.



g. Click on Import file  or press Ctrl+F and select audio and video files. Here, the files are Thunder and Main_Title.

h. This is the starting background sound and the title video for the movie.

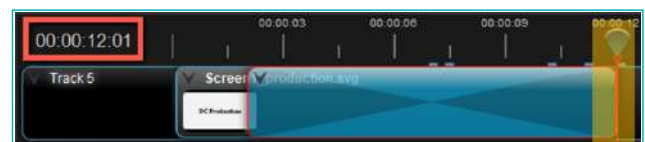


We want our audio (Thunder) to start along with the cloud effect. For this, add the audio to track 3 on the Timeline.

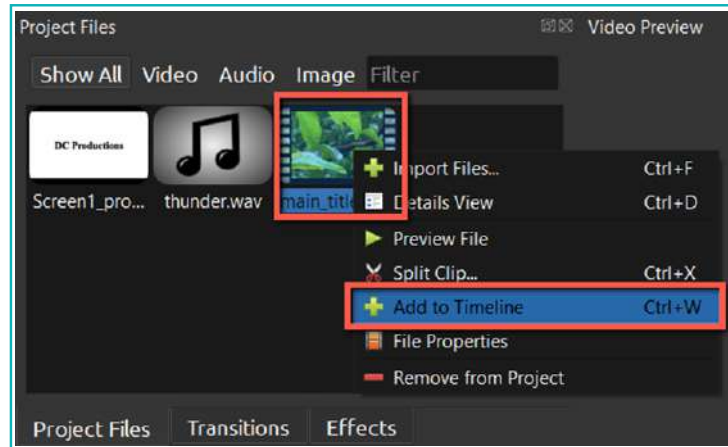


Now, we will add the movie title. We want to add the video file main_title_video as background on timeline track 4. It should trail the clip screen1_production.

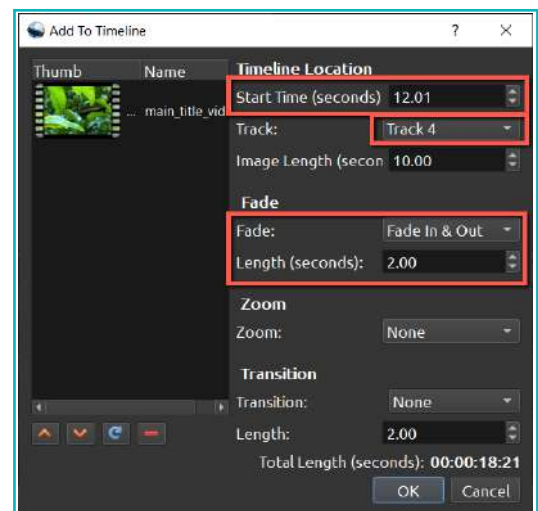
i. Place the play head at end of clip screen1 to read its end time. Here, it is 12.01 seconds.



- j. Right click on the video in Project Files and select 'Add to timeline'.

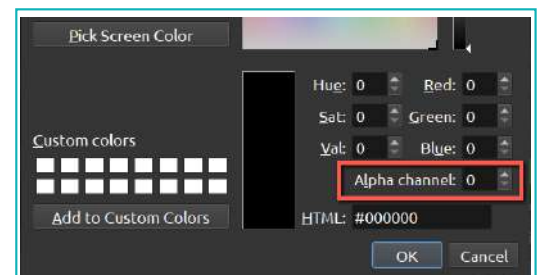
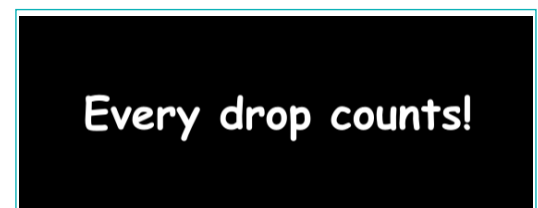


- k. Type the starting time as 12.01. The title clip will start at the end of clip screen1.
- l. Select track 4 of the timeline which is for videos files.
- m. Add fade in and fade out effects at the start and end of the video.



With this video as the background, we will add the title "Every drop counts!" to be displayed over it.

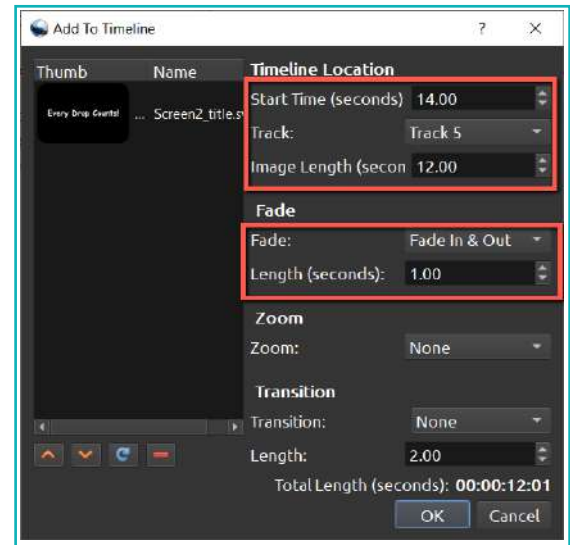
- n. Click on the title option or press Ctrl + T to add a title with the Sunset template.
- o. Choose a colour and font that suits the background video. Choose an option that contrasts the background so that it is visible.
- p. For a transparent background, set Alpha channel in Background Color to 0.



Our movie title is ready, but we still need to add our message. We will add the text in the paragraph we have. To display text over the video, place the clip Title Text at on track 5. Place it at the same time as the main title background video on track 4. Clips on higher tracks will be displayed over clips on lower tracks.

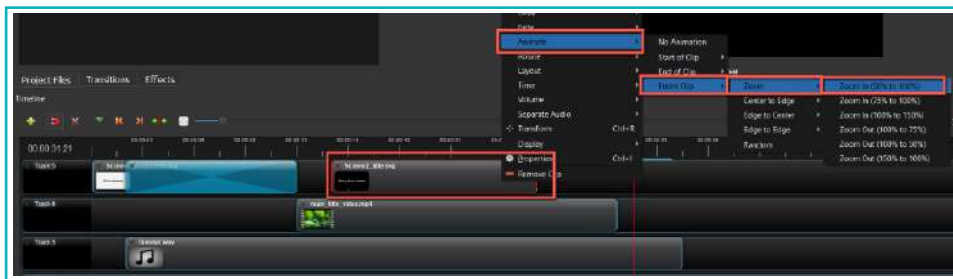
For example: In case of videos or photos, the clip is on track 4 will be displayed over clips on track 4 and so on.

- q. Add screen2_title to track 5 to start just after background clip starts. Here, the background clip starts at around 14 sec.
- r. Set clip or image length to 12 seconds to cover most of the video duration.
- s. Add fade in and fade out effects for 1 second.



The title is a movie's main identity. Various effects are used to highlight the title. We can add the zoom animation effect to the title.

- t. Right click on the Screen2_title on the timeline.
- u. Select duration of animation as Entire Clip. This will apply the effect on the whole clip.
- v. Select Zoom animation to zoom it from 50% to 100% and playback the video.



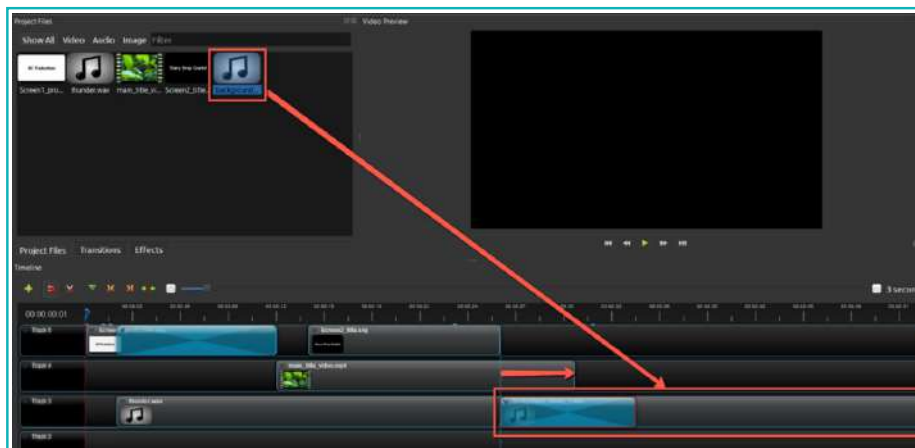
Exercise

Tick mark ☒ the correct answer

- 3** We can add a transparent background by setting alpha channel in Background Color to _____.
- | | | | |
|--------|--------------------------|--------|--------------------------|
| a. 0 | ☐ | b. 1 | ☐ |
| c. 256 | ☐ | d. 100 | ☐ |
- 4** The project file tab in the project library displays _____
- | | | | |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| a. visual effects | ☐ | b. transition effects | ☐ |
| c. image, audio and videos | ☐ | d. All of the above | ☐ |
- 5** The _____ feature makes it easier to place clips at exact locations like the start or end of other clips, or at the placeholder
- | | | | |
|-------------|--------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| a. Snapping | ☐ | b. Split | ☐ |
| c. Slice | ☐ | d. None of them | ☐ |

A movie is incomplete without good music. Music helps to keep viewers engaged.

- w. Add music1 audio to the project library so it can be used as background music for the rest of the video.
- x. Add the audio clip to the timeline such that it starts after the thunder audio ends. Here, the time is around 26 seconds.



When two clips overlap each other, a blue transition appears. It applies the default fade in and fade out effect to the clip.

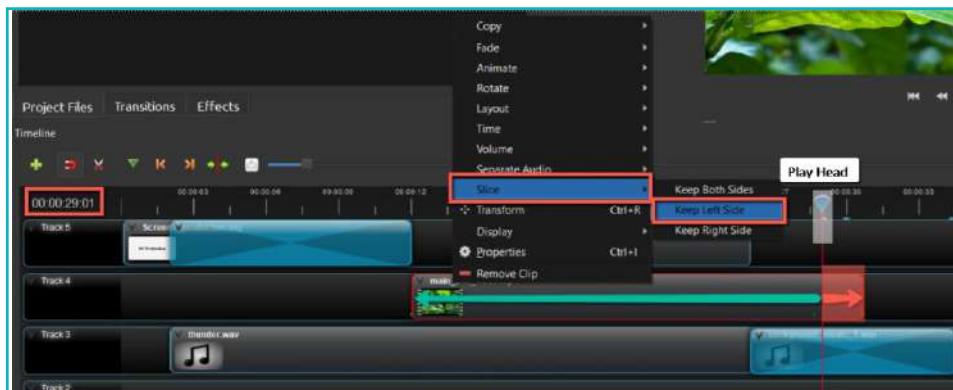
If a video clip is longer than required, we can cut it short with the Slice function.

Slice function

This function slices the video or audio clip in a track in to two parts. It is cut at the position of the play head. We can remove the unwanted part or keep both as separate clips.

Here, the background video clip of the title slide is too long, so we will cut it.

- Place the play head at the exact time where the clip needs to be split. In this video, it is 29.01 seconds.
- Right click on the clip and select Slice.
- Since we don't want the part on the right, select 'Keep Left Side'.

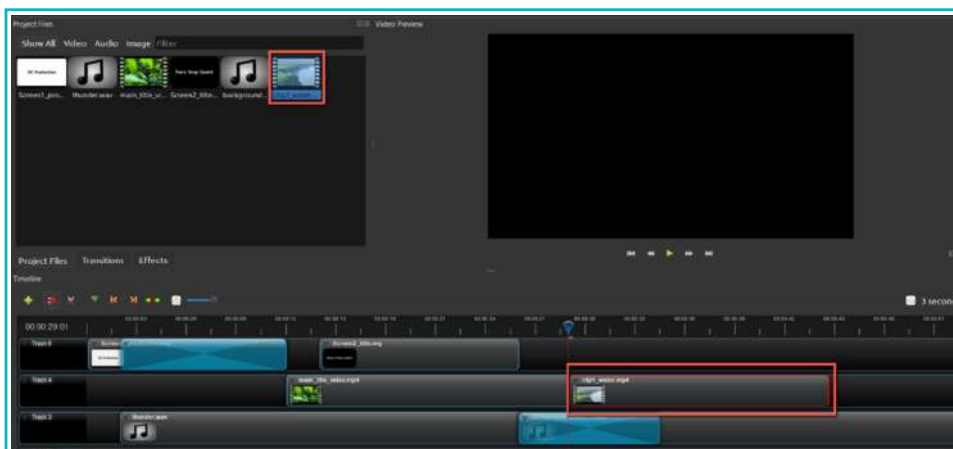


If a clip is sliced, fade in fade out effects have to be applied again. Here, the last part of the clip is deleted so the fade effect at the end will not work.

- Right click on the clip and remove the fade in option.
- Add a slow fade at the start and a fast fade at the end.

Now, to tell the rest of our story, we will add the next clip. Add the next file to the project library. Here, it is 'clip1_water'.

- Add the clip to track 4 on the timeline, after the main title background.
- Add slow fade in and slow fade out effects.

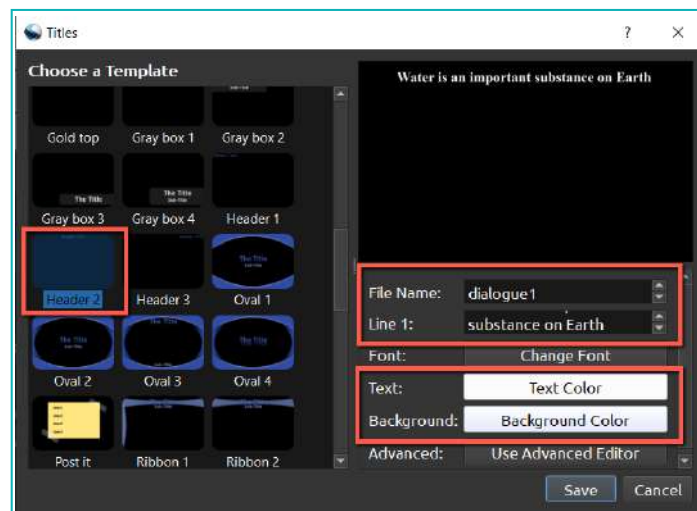


Let's add text on the video to get our message across. We can create an image with a dialogue or text with a transparent background. A screenshot of the background video clip can be used as reference to position the text.

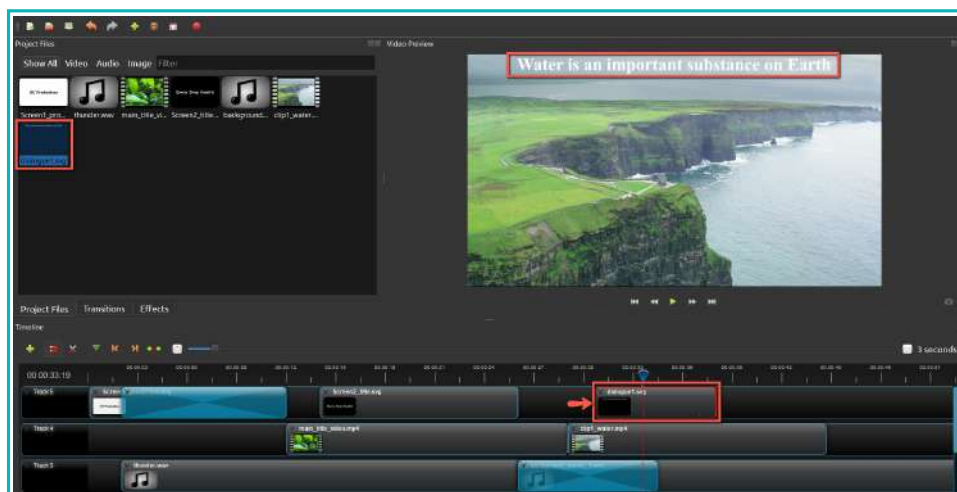
An audio narration can also be added to the video instead of text. Audio can be recorded and added in a track.

In this lesson, we will use the Titles feature to display text dialogues. But it has some limitations on the position of text in the video clip.

- h. Press Ctrl + T to add a title. Select Header2 template and name the clip "dialogue1".
- i. Add text "Water is an important substance on Earth." in line 1 with a transparent background and an appropriate colour.



- j. Add the dialogue clip on track 5, such that it starts a few seconds after the chosen video.
- k. Drag the right edge of clip to reduce its length, so that it ends halfway through the video clip. We want the dialogue to be displayed only for half of the video duration.
- l. Add a slow fade in at the start and a fast fade out at the end for better dialogue display.



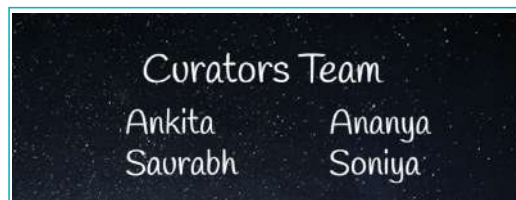
Similarly, add the next dialogue from our script which will cover the rest of clip1 with another template.



Add the rest of the video clips, audio tracks, and dialogues or titles to complete the movie.

At the end of any movie, the names of people who have worked on that movie are displayed. These are called end credits.

- m. We can use titles to create text for the credits.
- n. Use the Animate feature to move text from the bottom edge upwards to the centre and then to the top edge.
- o. Try out other animation effects to see how they look.



Titles and animation effects can be used to create moving text just like in films. We should credit the web resources we used and everyone who helped make the video.

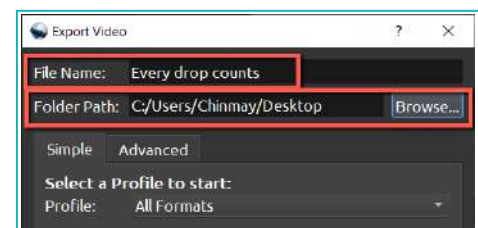
Export Video

Once the final video is finished, it can be converted into a single video file. Click on 'export video' in the toolbar.

- a. Select the name of the file and the location to save it in.
The video quality can also be selected.

The final video will appear on the Folder Path selected.

We can use any movie maker software, add images, text, and audios to create a movie. Information about a subject or topic, or a message can be spread to large audiences through movies. But use transitions wisely to add appropriate effects to the film.



This is so interesting! I can make another one about sustainable development goals for my school project.

You should! Why don't you make one with your friends?



Tech Flash

- **Project library** : It displays all the resources need to make a movie like project files, transitions, and effects.
- **Transition effects** : These are animation effects that are added to change from one scene to another.
- **Timeline** : This is the area where media clips are added in a sequence with respect to the time ruler. It has multiple layers called tracks.
- **Titles** : This tool helps to add text for titles with specific templates.
- **Tracks** : These are different layers on the timeline. The highest track number is the uppermost layer.
- **Slice** : It is tool to split audio and video clips. We can keep the parts we need.